



arcade ■ digit diary

The Chinese Connection

Going places in the global village

There's more to Digit than just exhaustive research and tests to stay apace with the latest technologies and products, or taking apart the latest high-falutin' devices in the Test Centre and then putting them back together. The job often calls for stepping out of our hi-tech testing labs to attend seminars organised by peers in the media and different segments of the technology industry.

In a similar vein, Hakim, head of our Test Centre set sail for Beijing, China, this month to attend a conference organised by Canon. The three-day-long conference was a great opportunity to understand issues concerning the printer market worldwide.

But the China trip turned out to be a learning experience in more ways than one. On the last day of the conference, Canon had organised a grand send-off dinner for the 60-odd delegates. The Indian delegation, consisting of six people from the technology industry, including Hakim, decided to use the free time before dinner to see something of the Forbidden City.

After an eyeful of sightseeing, it was time to head for dinner, but asking directions was rather tiresome, as nobody

seemed to understand English. Accustomed to being prepared for all eventualities, Hakim had made sure to carry along the restaurant's visiting card and managed to locate the restaurant by relying heavily on sign language and pointing to the card when asking for directions.

any of the other delegates then inquiries in pidgin Chinese about for 60 people from Canon to be the restaurant only led to confusion on the part of the restaurant. the prospect of arranging seating for so many. Finally, they managed to make some headway: it was so that maybe the dinner was being another branch of the restaurant. Tiananmen Square.

More sign language, pidgin and 40 minutes later, Hakim and his companions located the restaurant only to find it closed. One decided to give up easily and decided to call the Canon office and find out where the venue was. As it turned out, they had gone to the right place the first time, but the restaurant delegation was late and had reached there after Hakim's friends had left for Tiananmen Square. By now, everyone was terribly hungry and the prospect of another 30-minute wait for dinner was too much. Hakim won over the temptation of waiting out some more of authentic Chinese cuisine and the weary sixsome headed for the nearest McDonald's.



ILLUSTRATION: Mahesh Benkar

By the time they found their way to the restaurant, it was already a little after the stipulated hour. But they couldn't see

When the Cats are Away...

This is a story of the three pairs of shoulders that carry the weight of Digit, or rather a story of when they were away! Vinit Aggarwal, our editor, Sveta Basraon, our features editor, and Shivshankar Pillai, our head designer, midwife Digit through the production cycle every month.

But this month, as each of them got called away, the rookies came out to play! Pillaiji, as we affectionately call him, went on a long-postponed trip to his native God's own country, while Sveta trotted to discover the wonders of Pachmarhi, Madhya Pradesh. Vinit, on the other hand, got called back by a somewhat hostile mother-

ship (read: He decided to go home before he forgot what it looked like. Luckily for him, his driver still remembered the address).

Those who were left to hold up the fort got to play the favourite game of *magazine magazine* with Digit, much to the Marketing department's horror. As soon as our publisher heard of the decreased 'body count', he sent us a reassuring mail on how we could always turn to him for guidance; the consumer service people began practising their 'I'm sorry your issue is late' speech even as the rest of the company cast nervous glances in our direction.

But we had our priorities right—single-mindedly focused on brewing the perfect coffee. Our writer Veer, found the perfect opportunity to put his theory of breeding to test. Job definitions blurred non-existence, so Ahmed metamorphosed into a technical editor, Marco, the head writers supervised design ideas and tweaked around with the layouts, and them about at Mitali's—our ever-smiling copy-editor—whims and fancies.

But surprisingly, Digit came out with all pages intact. Moral of the story: never underestimate the power of a pot of coffee!